accident, but for good reason. The political calculation has always been that the legislatures have little to gain, but much to lose, by codification. Had the judgement in the *Searchlight* case been decisively overturned, privileges may well have been codified as the Constitution contemplated.

The Supreme Court's decision was not received well by Parliament and state legislative assemblies across the country. The decision was heavily criticized at a Conference of Presiding Officers of Legislative Bodies held in Bombay in January 1965. The conference resolved that the Supreme Court 'reduced legislatures to the status of inferior courts' and negated the intentions of the framers of the Constitution. It was therefore recommended that the Constitution be amended to make clear that legislatures have the exclusive authority to adjudicate and punish cases of contempt, whether committed by a member or a stranger, and whether inside or outside the assembly.

Counter-efforts were made by lawyers and bar associations to educate the public about the judgement and clarify any misconceptions. This included a statement signed by a group of lawyers and public intellectuals, including Setalvad, followed by a published brochure. The Bar Association of India also organized a symposium chaired by Pandit H.N. Kunzru, a distinguished parliamentarian and leader of the freedom movement. Setalvad's speech at the symposium played down the narrative of conflict between the legislature and the judiciary, with Setalvad describing the case as a recalibration between citizens' rights and the rights of the legislatures.[22] Ultimately, the proposals to amend the Constitution were not pursued, and the Supreme Court's judgement remained intact.

There was still the small matter of Keshav Singh's petition being decided by the high court. The judgement turned out to be anticlimactic, for the high court held that there was no reason to believe that the assembly's decision was in bad faith and that it lacked the jurisdiction to entertain Singh's petition.[23] Upon concluding that the assembly had the power to imprison for contempt and impose the sentence it did on Singh, the court would not consider the propriety or legality of the assembly's decision.